

JULY 1-15, 1980

a flock of sheep to a lion's den. Maoist havens like Bastar and Koraput should be declared disturbed areas and handed over to the Army without delay to flush out the armed ultras with air support. The CRPF and BSF may be deployed to protect villagers in the disturbed areas.

Simultaneously, action must be taken on priority for the economic development of the areas which have been neglected for decades.

J.N. MAHANTY, *Puri*

Match Point

There is no doubt that all marriages must be legal as per the law of the land ("Double Fault", April 19). Therefore, it is for Sania Mirza and her family to either consider or ignore Shoaib Malik's liaison with Ayesha Siddiqui. If some people feel a legal marriage has not taken place, only the affected party, if any, has the right to legal recourse. There should be no one else concerned with the wedding. The Sania-Shoaib marriage might lead to better relations between India and Pakistan.

MAHESH KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

Retail Mess

The unsatisfactory performance of malls underlines the importance of customer tastes and buying habits in planning sales and marketing ("Malls Not Well", April

19). National culture is a determinant of customer behaviour. A majority of Indians enjoy prolonged price bargaining, seeking hidden variety, home delivery and credit purchase without a credit card. This gives them the pride of buying competence. The malls have western splendour and glitter but lack the excitement of domestic buying.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY,

Pune

continue until a tired public forgets, and gets on with its toil for a living. We need a national learning process and focused follow-up action with a clear long-term strategy and proactive safety measures that can be implemented.

Fire-fighting equipment must be procured so that such horror stories do not recur anywhere in India.

VINOD KUMAR B.,

Bangalore



RAVI S. SAHANI / www.indiatodayimages.com

Despite the hospital boom, the rural poor are taken care of by state governments, NGOs and religious organisations. Hence the 'boom' in question does not deserve such accolades.

DR ACHAR, *Bangalore*

Fighting Fire

The fire at Stephen Court in Kolkata was a tragedy waiting to happen ("Wake up Call", April 12). We can expect many more such harrowing disasters because basic safety norms are cynically flouted for petty profit. The flurry of sick buck-passing by inept ministers and officials will

Saffron Surge

The BJP capturing the Bangalore City Corporation with a sweeping majority is a big boost to the party ("The Big Bang", April 19). Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa can take credit for a marvellous performance.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,

Thiruvananthapuram

India After Sanjay

It had the makings of a Greek tragedy. There was the obsessive taste for power, the reckless addiction to speed and the consuming urge to be glorified. There was a kingdom to take over, and legions of admiring lieutenants. Few men could have asked for more—and got it. The world, it seemed, was at the calling of Sanjay Gandhi, MP. But there was a fatal flaw, as in all tragedies. When it struck, in the shape of a malevolent red aircraft, the instant heroism metamorphosed into instant martyrdom and the glorification became absolute. Last week, as the surging crowds pressed towards the funeral cortege of Sanjay Gandhi all along the 12-km route to Shantivana, they invoked the image of an immortal. *Sanjay Gandhi amar rahe*, they shouted, participating in one of the grandest but unofficial state funerals ever organised in Delhi, and the other slogan that caught the popular imagination extended the image further: *Jab tak suraj chand rahega, Sanjay tera naam rahega*. **by Sunil Sethi**



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